

Invasion Genomics

Who I am



Dr Ang McGaughran

PI of the Invasomics Lab,

University of Waikato

INVASOMICS LAB

Expertise:

- Invasion genomics!
- Invertebrate ecology

THE UNIVERSITY OF WAIKATO

Te Whare Wānanga o Waikato



Who are you?

Pop into the slack channel:

- Your name
- Where you are zooming in from
- Your career stage



Expectations / learning outcomes

My assumptions:

That you have a basic (or more) understanding of genomics and evolutionary biology

Familiarity with R



Expectations / learning outcomes

After completing this introductory course, you will have more confidence to analyse your own data:

> What kinds of concepts to consider, questions to ask, methods to use, and interpretations to make



Expectations / learning outcomes

I will focus on explaining methods at a high level, but will not go deeply into algorithm explanations**



**Refer to the software manuals and/or associated journal publications for these details

Workflow

Day One: Movement dynamics

Day Two: Adaptation dynamics

Day Three: Environment dynamics



Workflow

Day One: Movement dynamics

Day Two: Adaptation dynamics

Day Three: Environment dynamics

Each day: Start with presentation, then move into R



Support

Dedicated slack channel – ask questions there!

My replies might come at odd times; thanks to the Physalia team for help with facilitation!

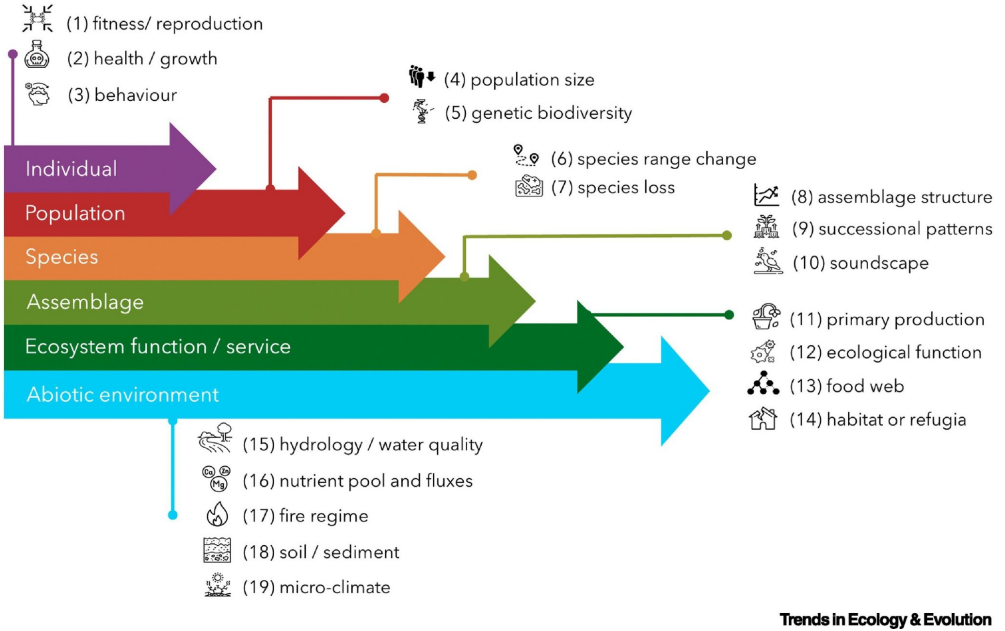


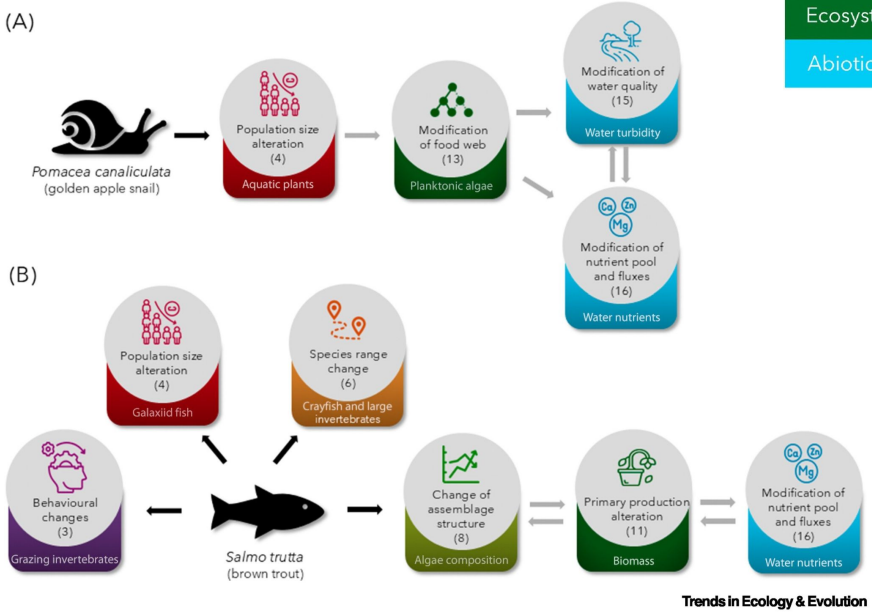
Invasive species

A species that has moved to an area outside of the area *in which it evolved*, and there *causes harm* to the environment, economy, or society



Invasion impact

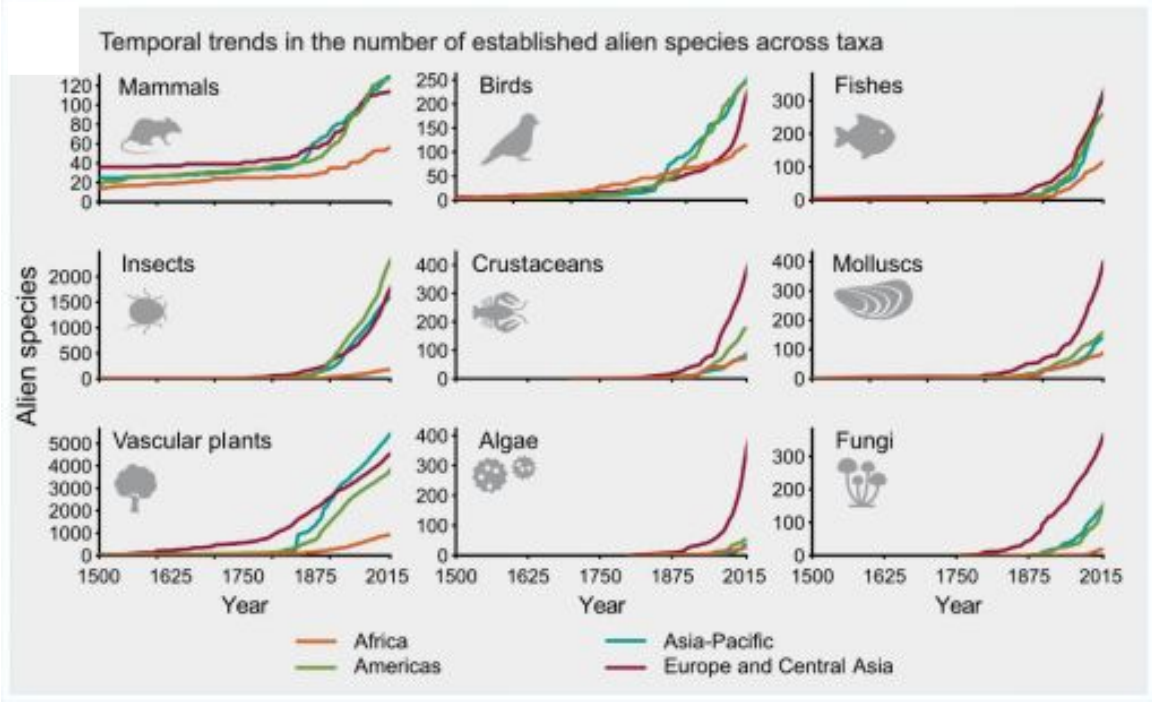


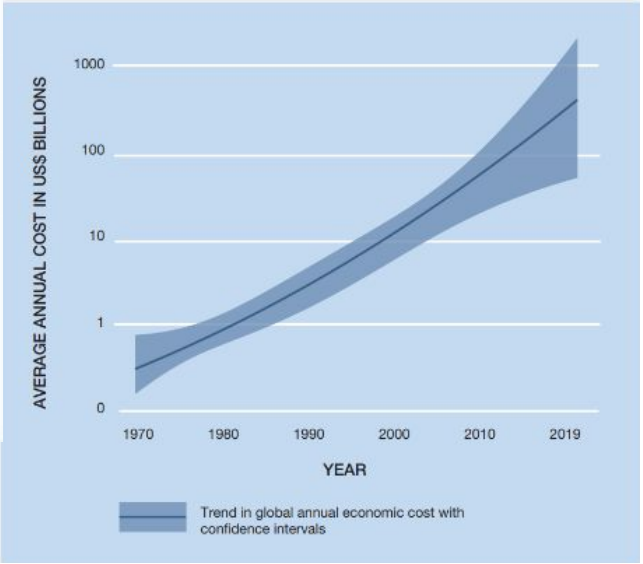


DOI: 10.1016/j.tree.2025.03.010

Invasion trends

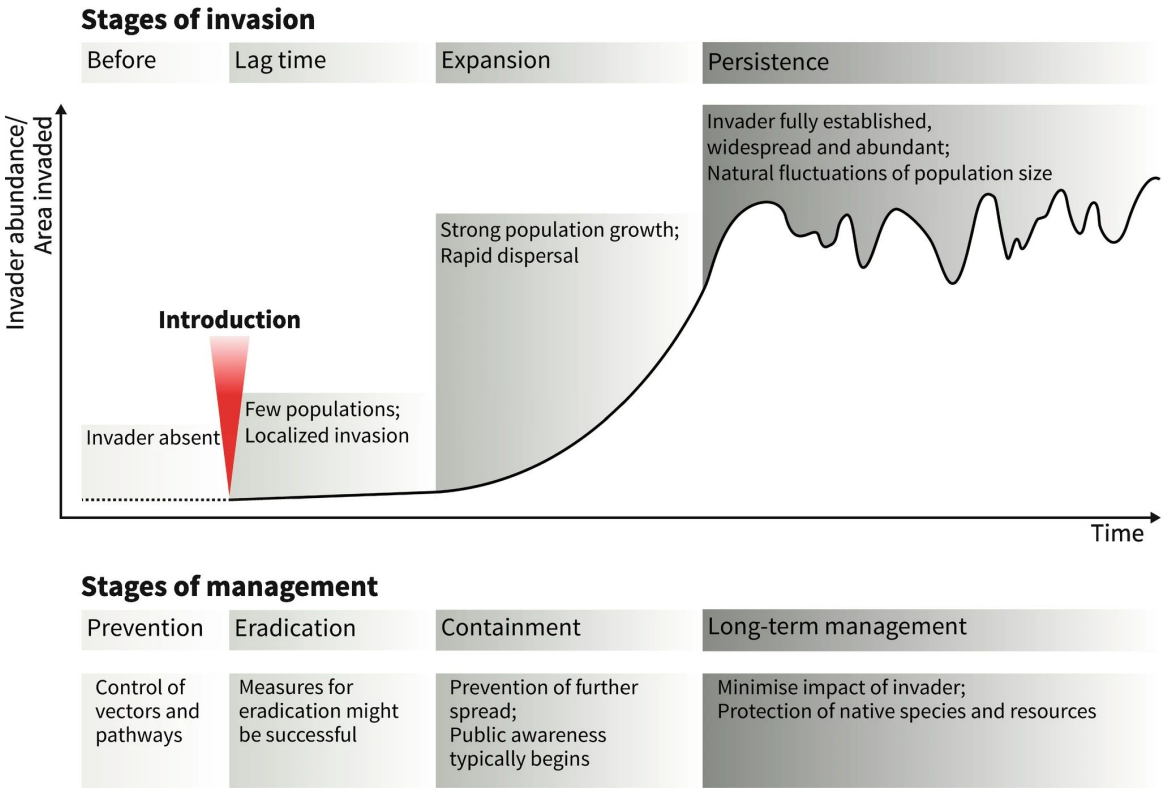




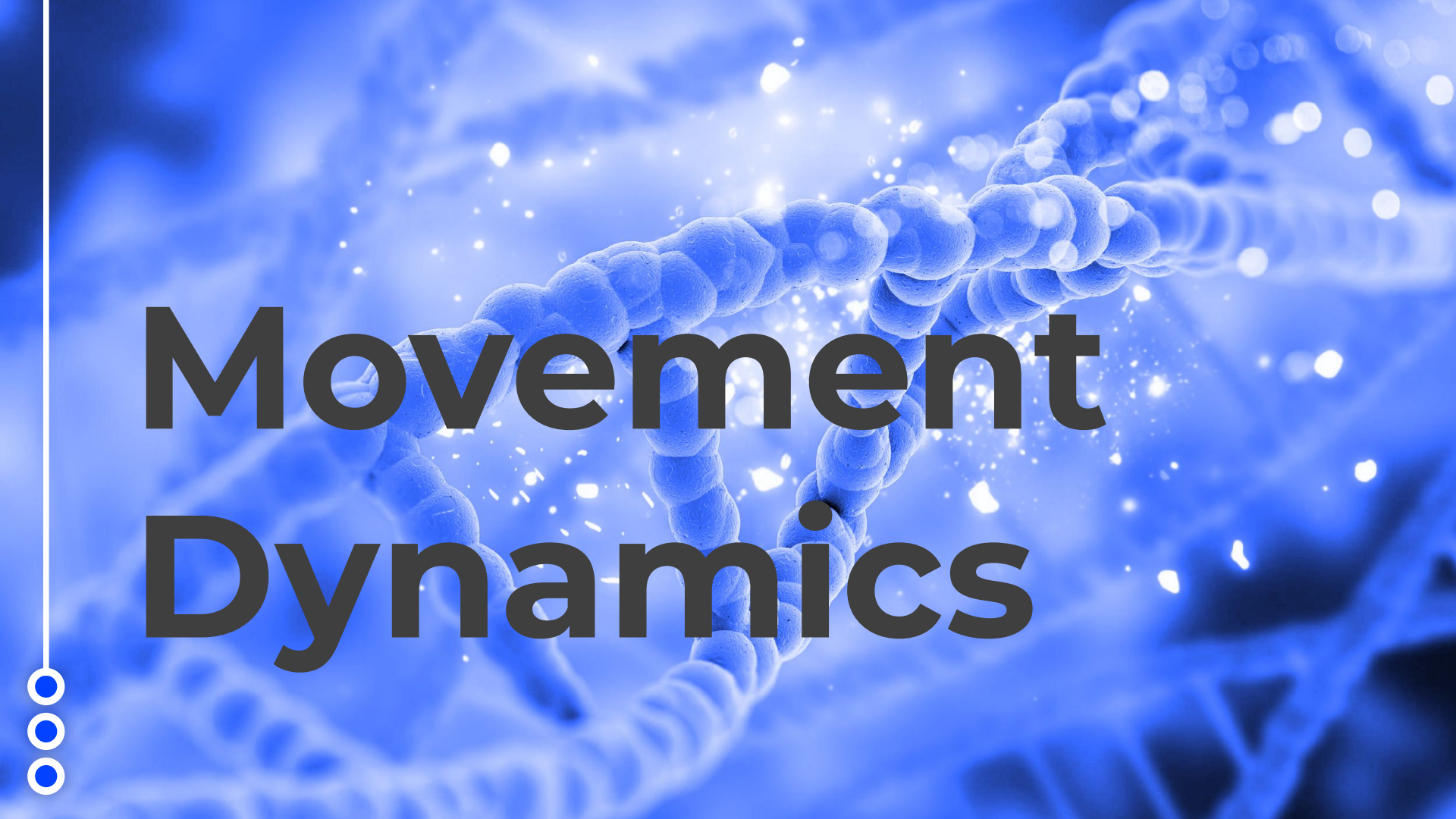


IPBES (2023). Thematic Assessment Report on Invasive Alien Species

Invasion curve



DOI: 10.1007/978-3-319-93284-2_8


Movement
Dynamics

Day One focus

Inferring:

- Population structure
- Invasion sources/pathways

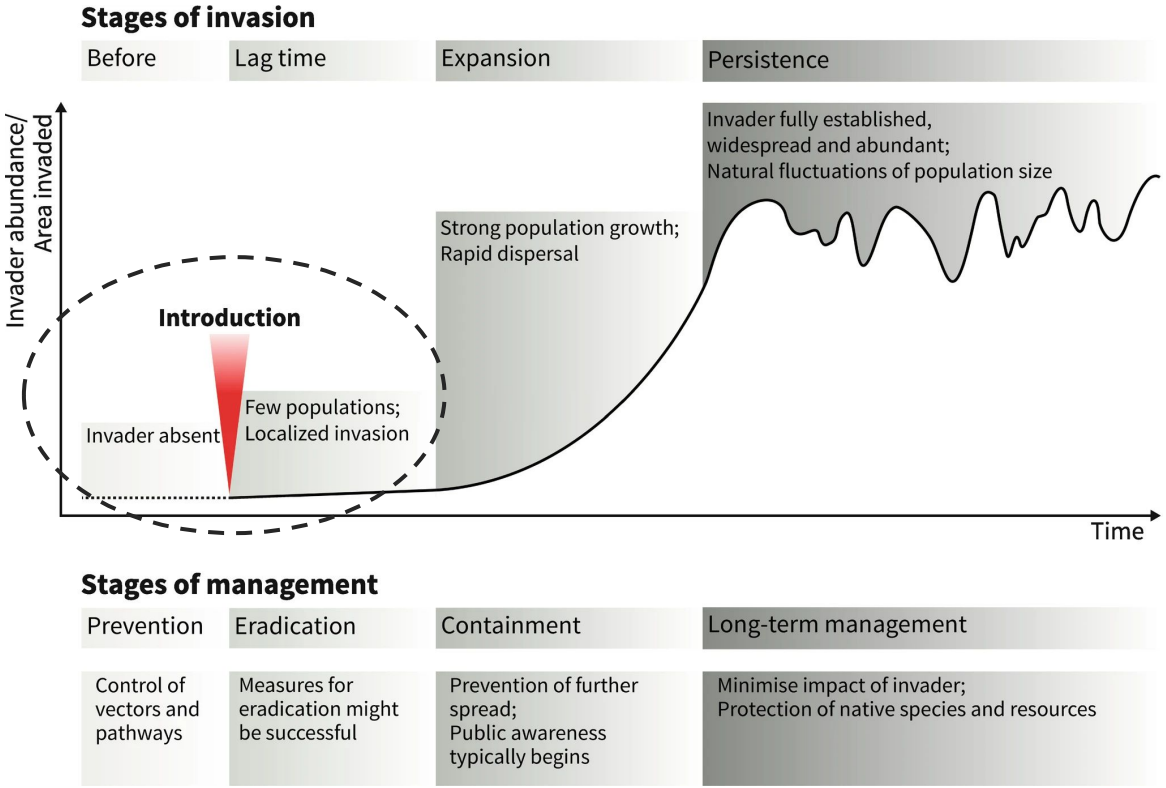
Introduction to invasion genomics and the key kinds of research questions and methods we use

Overview of the tutorial dataset



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Invasion curve



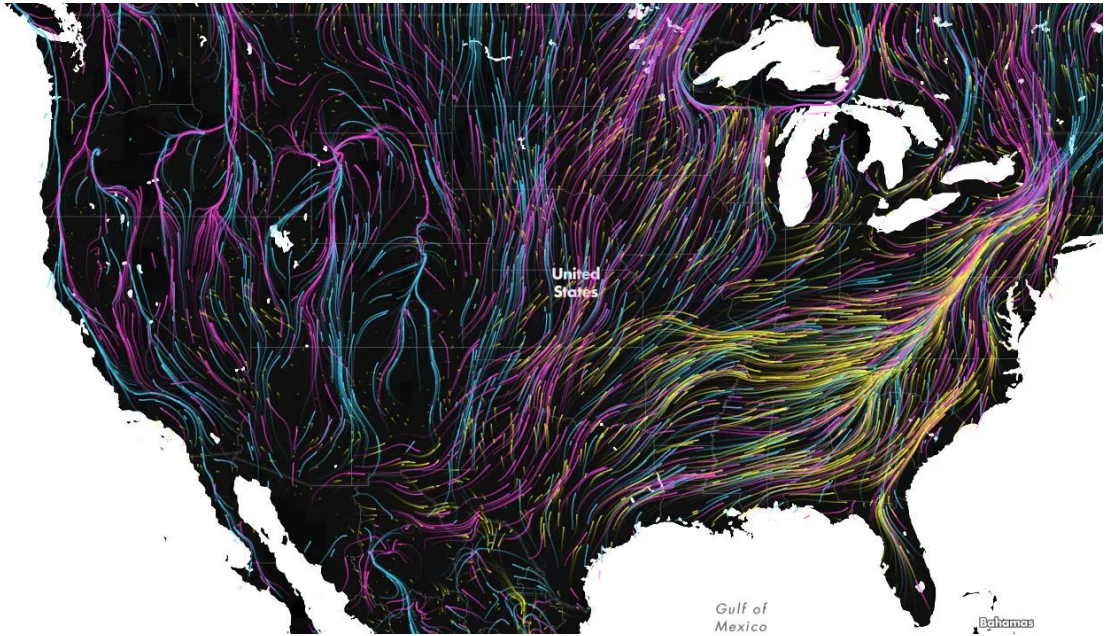
DOI: 10.1007/978-3-319-93284-2_8

MOVEMENT

Movement dynamics

Why should we care about movement in invasion biology?

How can we use genomic data to tell us about movement?



Migration in motion: Visualising species movements due to climate change

https://blog.nature.org/2016/08/19/migration-in-motion-visualizing-species-movements-due-to-climate-change/

MOVEMENT

Genomic data

What kinds of questions can we ask?

Origin and source populations: Where did the invaders come from?

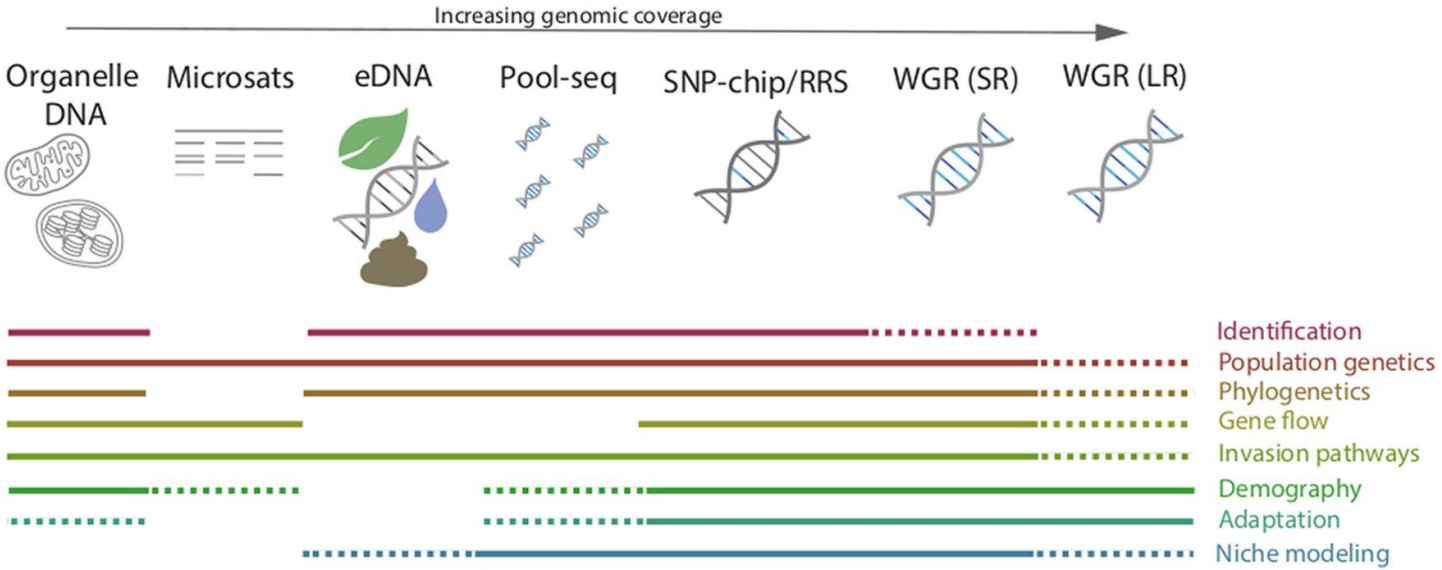
Number of introduction events: Single vs multiple introductions?

Genetic bottlenecks and founder effects: How did the introduction affect genetic diversity?

Cryptic invasions: Can we detect hidden or morphologically similar species?

Genomic tools

What kind of data can we use?



DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/gbe/evad230

MOVEMENT

Common analyses

Population structure:

Populations exist across geographic space

Quantifying population structure tells us how different populations are

How much gene flow is occurring



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Fst

Ranges from 0 to 1; a measure of genetic distance across populations

Proportion of total observed allele frequency variance that is attributable to allele frequency differences between two groups, averaged across genome-wide SNPs (though note that other definitions of F_{ST} exist)

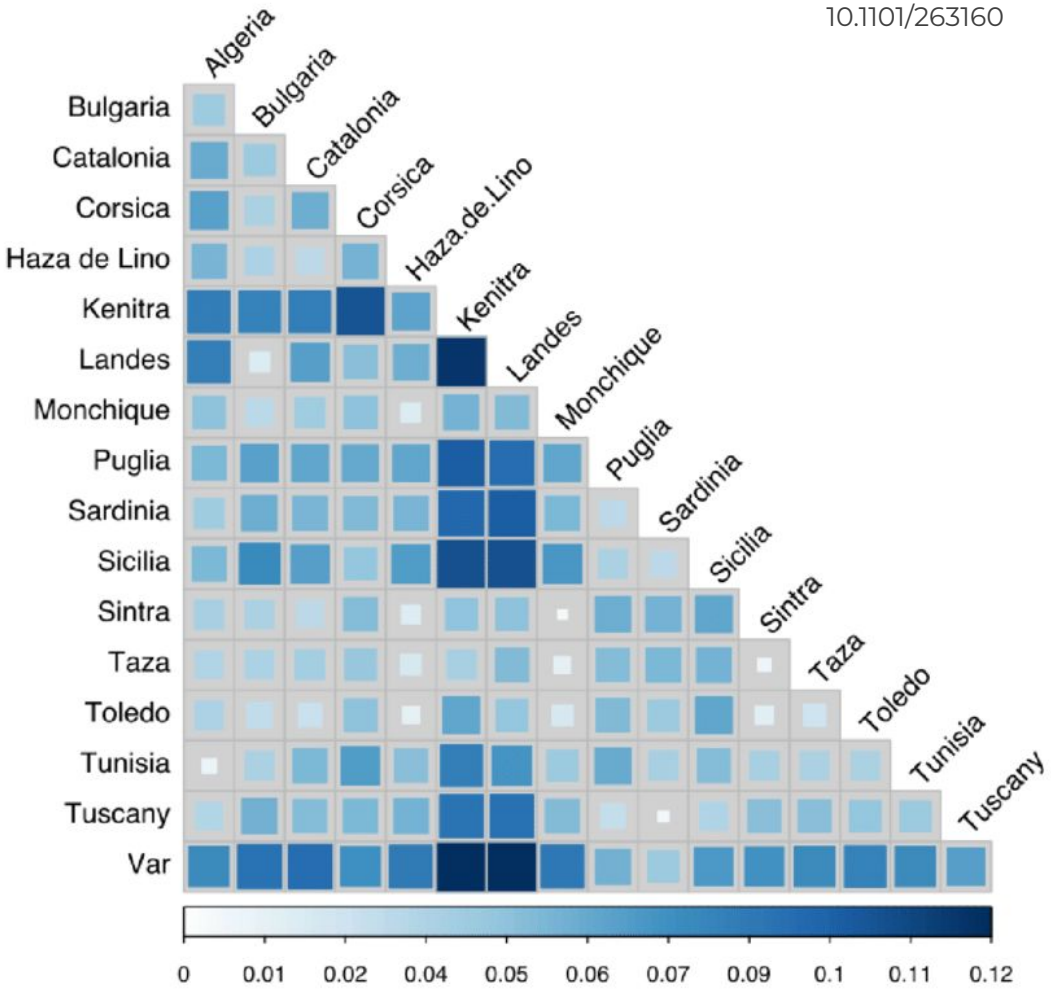
0 = no structure, freely exchanging genes, one large metapopulation

1 = full structure, populations fixed for alternate alleles, no gene flow

***Tractable with traditional population genetic tools, but genomic scale provides greater statistical power and precision from less individuals

Fst

Example shows ...



10.1101/263160

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Fst

Like PCA (next), F_{ST} is sensitive to sample size and number of SNPs, also potentially affected by SNP array ascertainment

Different demographic processes can lead to similar F_{ST} patterns

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Common analyses

Visualising population structure

PCA

Bayesian clustering methods

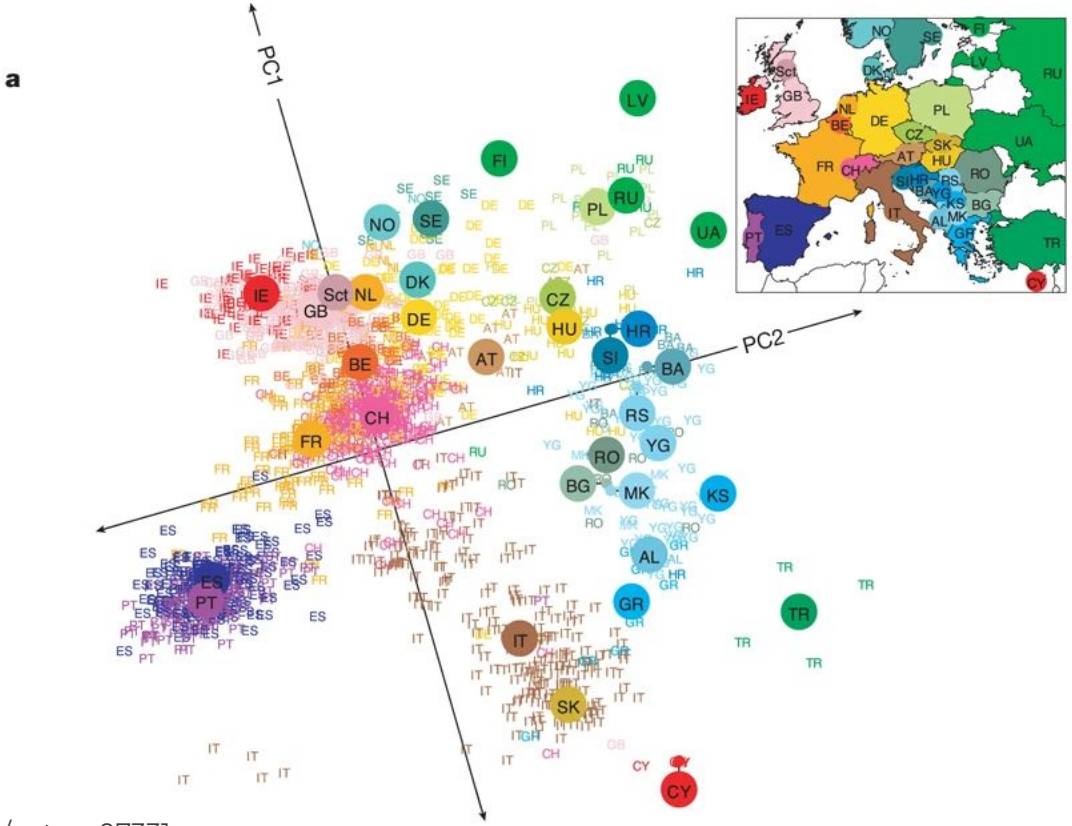
Illustrate the results of processes that affect the whole genome, e.g., population size, migration rates

Considered in a landscape context, can identify dispersal barriers, areas of high/low gene flow



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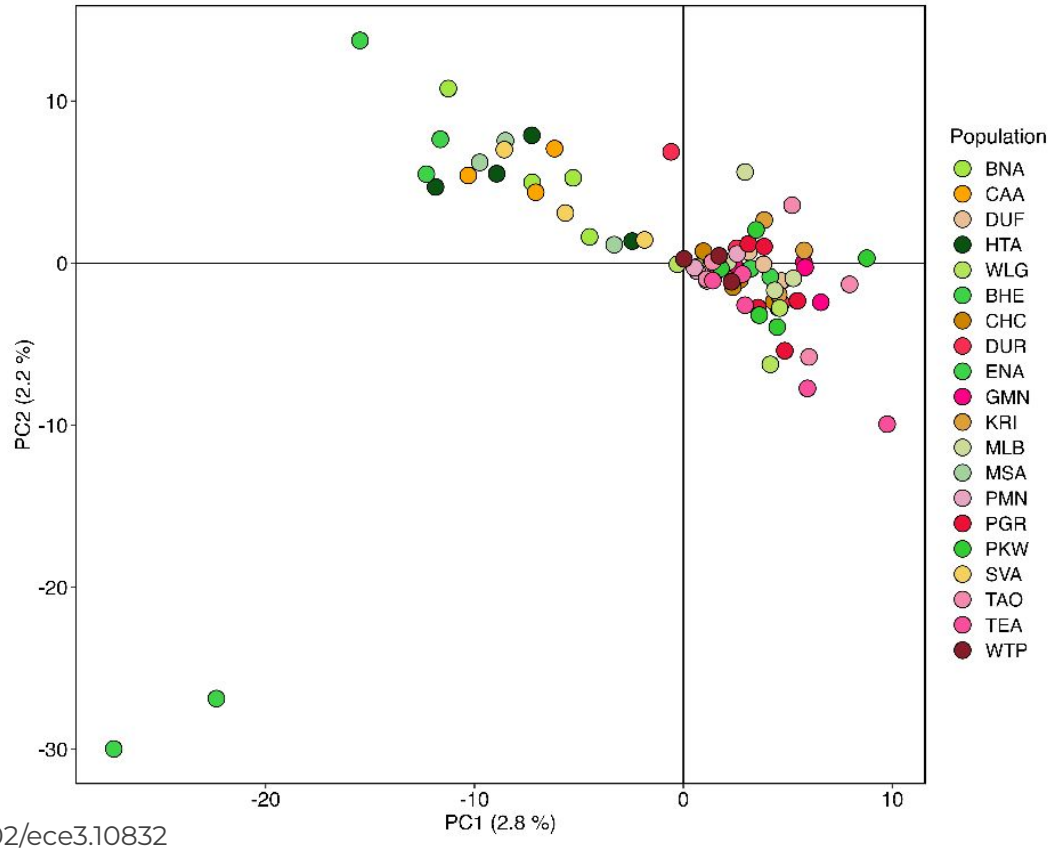
PCA



https://doi.org/10.1038/nature07331

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PCA



https://doi.org/10.1002/ece3.10832

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PCA

PCA efficiently summarises key patterns in the data in a few dimensions

But, interpreting the underlying factors leading to these patterns can be challenging:

Recently isolated groups in a populations' history can have a big influence; populations with larger sample sizes can make up larger proportions of the overall variation; batch effects in genotyping (e.g., when combining data from multiple sequencing runs); ascertainment bias

PCA assumes that SNPs are independent (e.g., unlinked) → removing those sites can reduce power compared to methods that can retain them

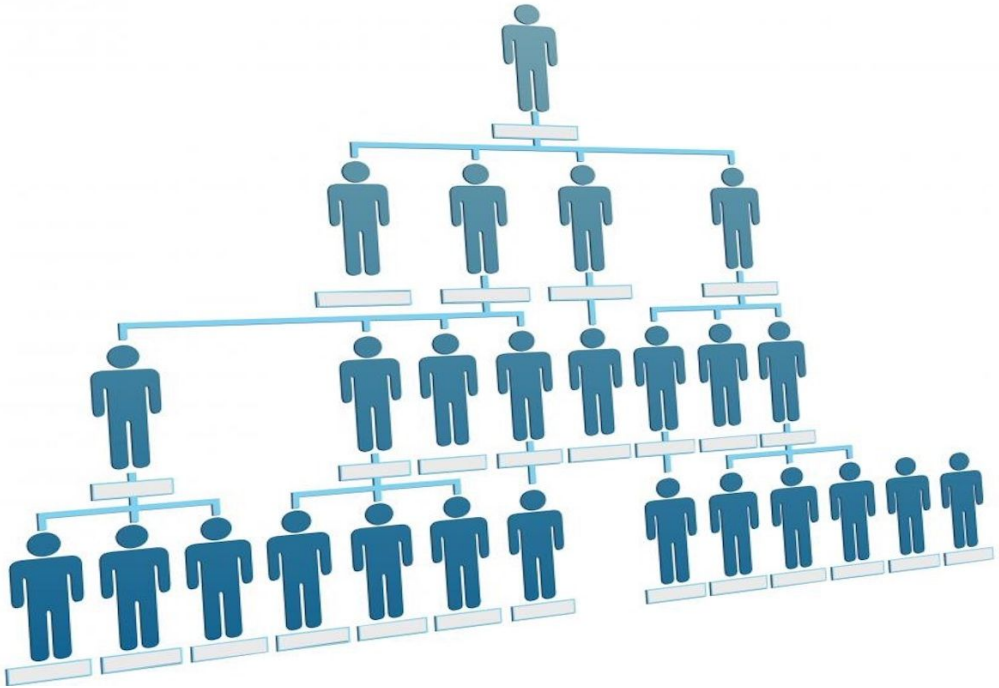
Bayesian clustering

Many methods:

sNMF, admixture, STRUCTURE, ...

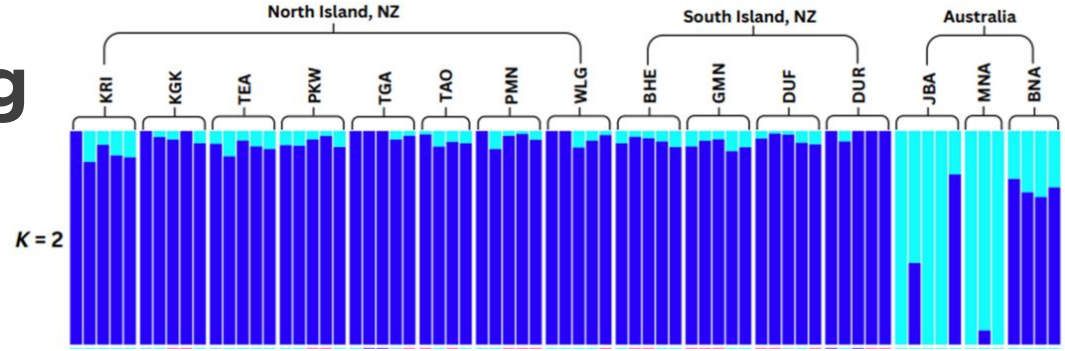
Based on allele or haplotype sharing + LD

Infers number of genetic clusters in the data *and* the shared ancestry between individuals



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Bayesian clustering



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https://doi.org/10.1002/ece3.10832

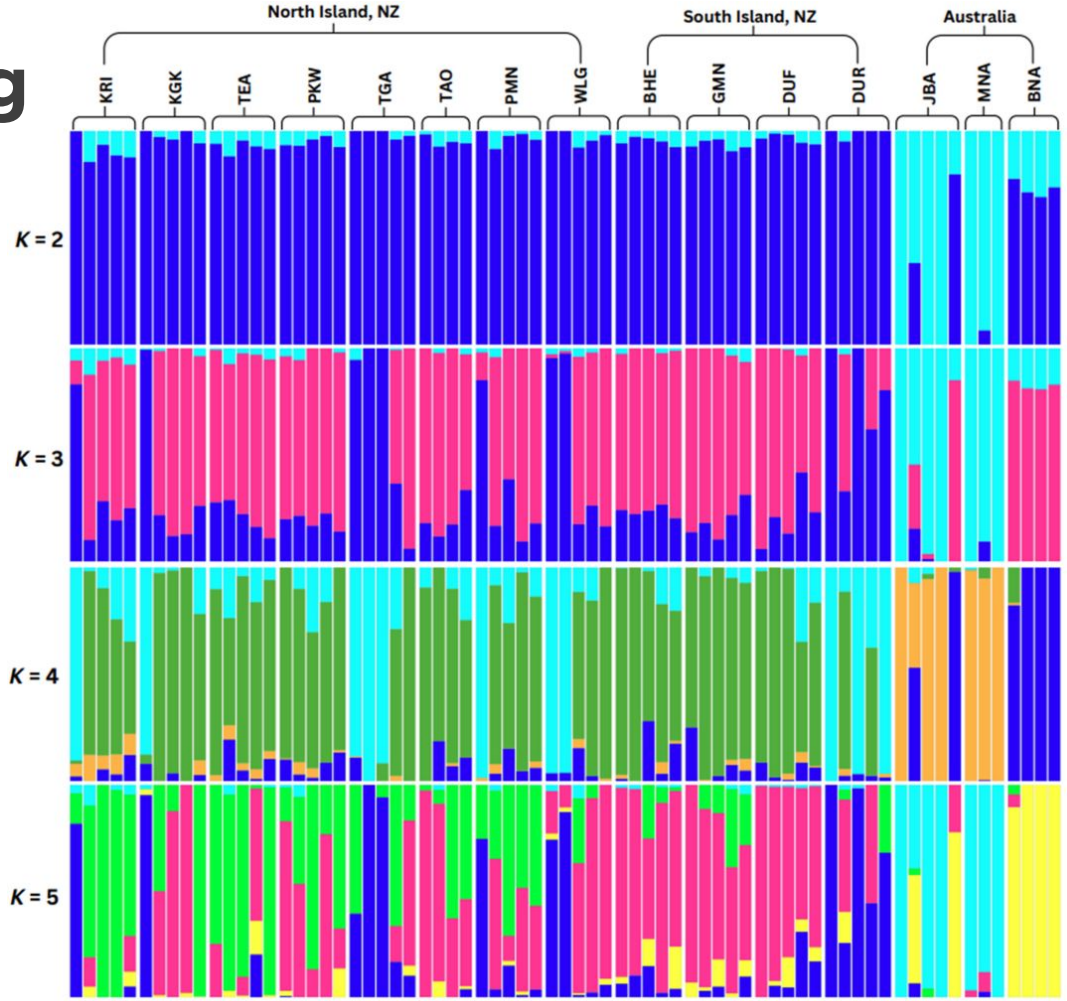
Bayesian clustering

K = 2 optimal, but in practice we tend to look at a range of values

What does this plot show?

Clear similarity among invasive populations - no structure; high gene flow

Hint of BNA derivation?



https://doi.org/10.1002/ece3.10832

Bayesian clustering

Choosing appropriate K values can be challenging – though common to relate to geography, unlikely that any given K has a true biological interpretation

Results can change depending on the set of SNPs, composition of the individuals in the dataset, and K value

E.g., some individuals might be placed in clusters that reflect isolation relative to other samples versus true admixture patterns

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Population assignment

As for other methods, can address diverse questions from measuring population connectivity to detecting dispersal and migration events

Model-based clustering methods like STRUCTURE designed to infer population structure, can also probabilistically assign individuals to inferred populations

Bayesian approaches assign individuals based on posterior probability they originate from each putative source population given their genotype – individual assigned to population with highest posterior probability or considered a migrant

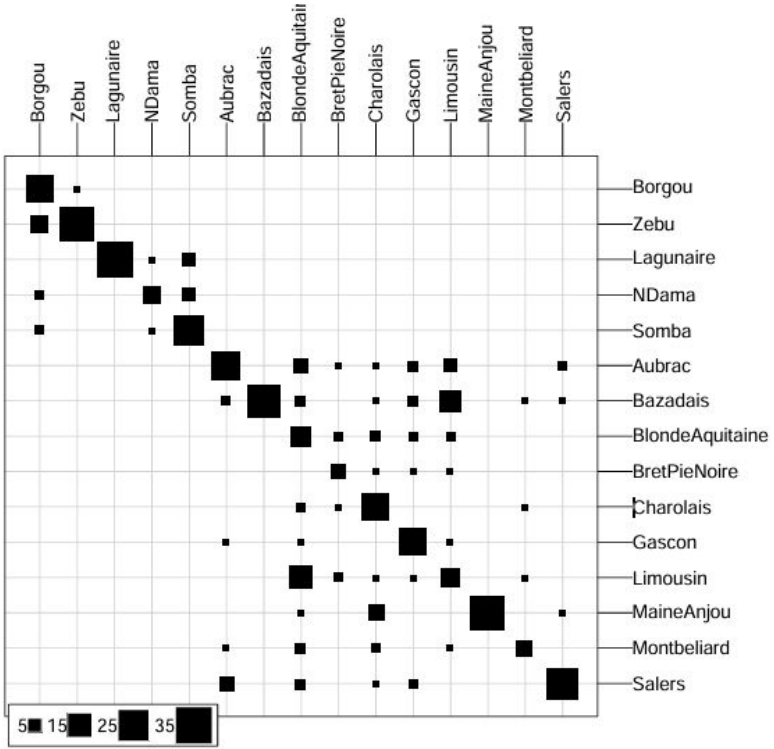
Also ML approaches (e.g., R's assignPOP, extends DAPC)

Population assignment

DAPC

K-means to infer number of clusters based on maximising variation between groups and build model; then predict population membership for samples not included in the training dataset

Columns = actual clusters of predicted individuals, rows = their inferred clusters



Groups fairly well retrieved, but some individuals not so good

From DAPC tutorial manual

Case study 1

Evolutionary Applications
Open Access



ORIGINAL ARTICLE | Open Access

Tracking the North American Asian Longhorned Beetle Invasion With Genomics

Mingming Cui, Amanda D. Roe, Brian Boyle, Melody Keena, Yunke Wu, W. Evan Braswell, Michael T. Smith, Ben Gasman, Juan Shi, Marion Javal, Geraldine Roux ... See all authors

First published: 19 November 2024 | https://doi.org/10.1111/eva.70036 | Citations: 2

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Case study 1



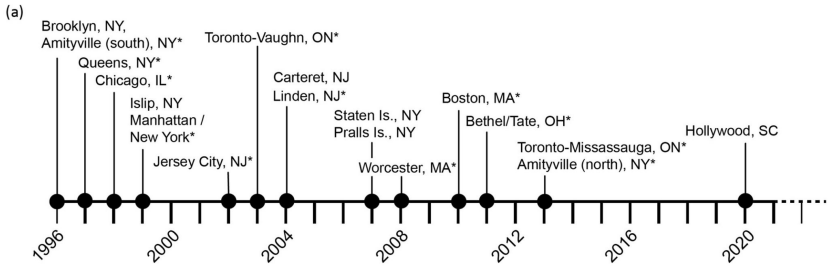
Asian longhorned beetle (*Anoplophora glabripennis*)

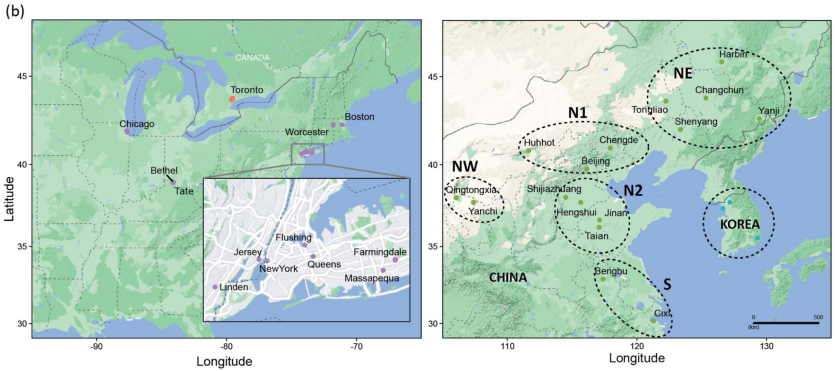
Damage to forest ecosystems

Effective management requires knowledge of invasion history

2,768 genome-wide SNPs

Focus on populations in N. America



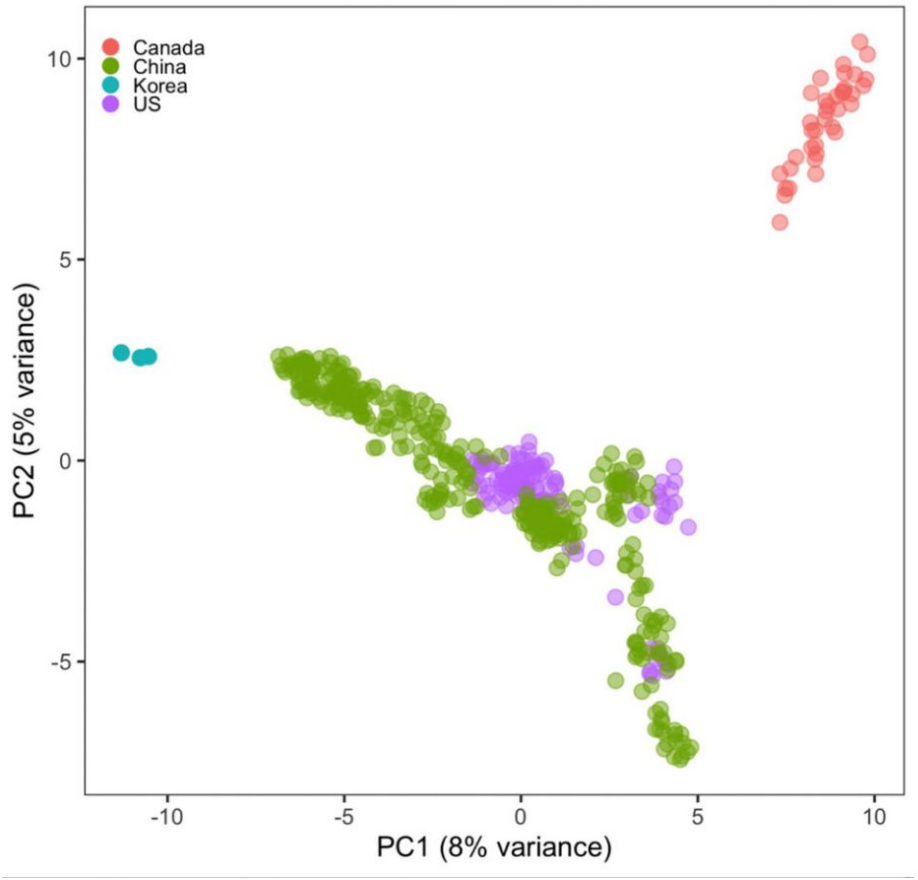


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Case study 1

Native populations show distinct regional clusters

US samples grouped within Chinese regions

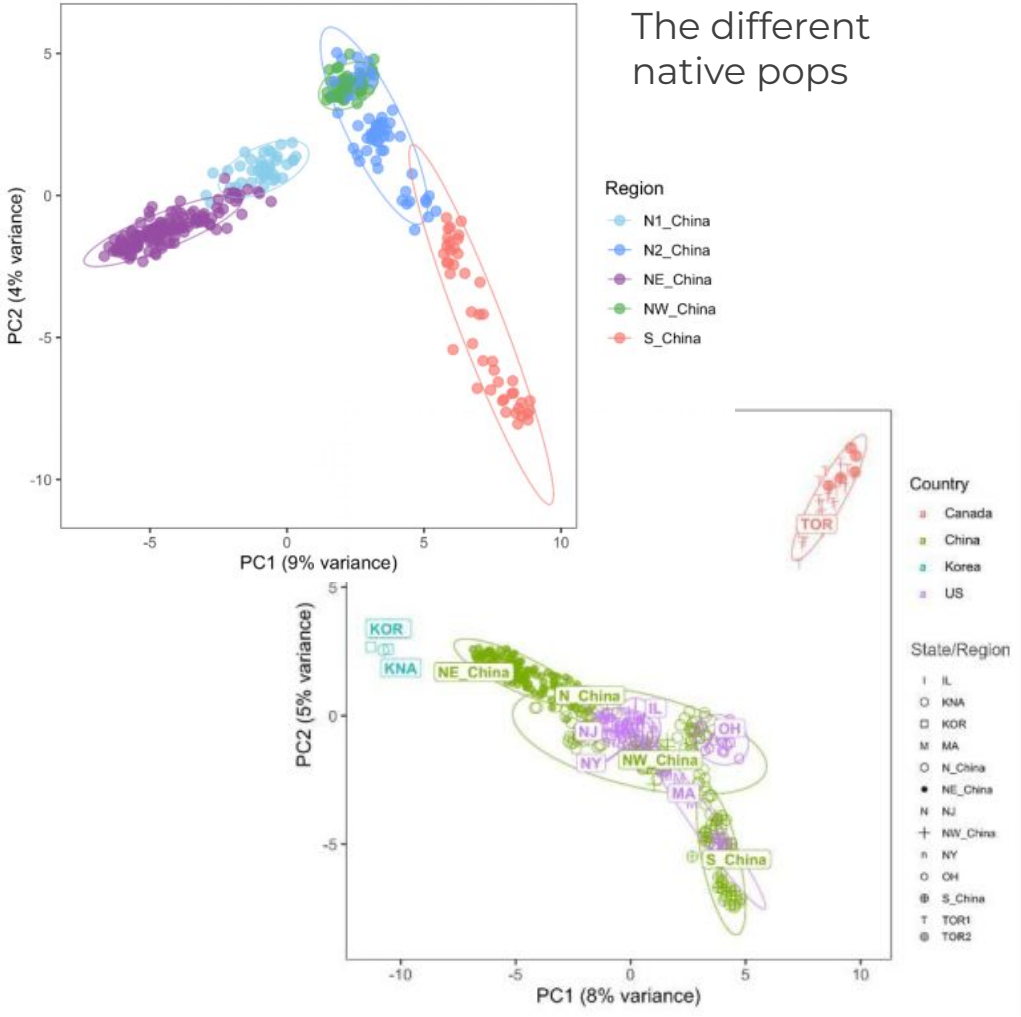


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Case study 1

Native populations show distinct regional clusters

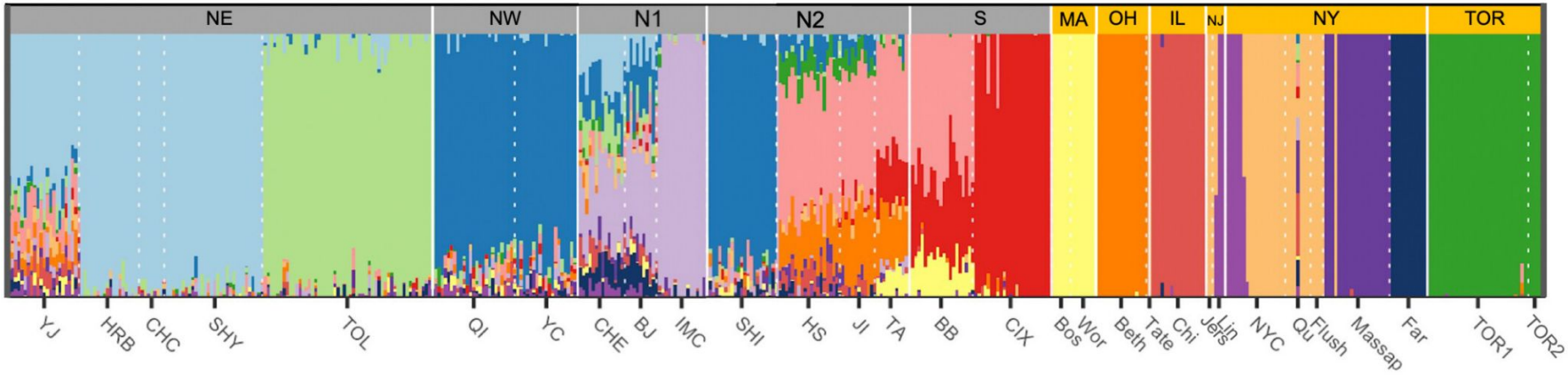
US samples grouped within Chinese regions



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Case study 1

K = 14 optimal



Native pops on left; invasive on right

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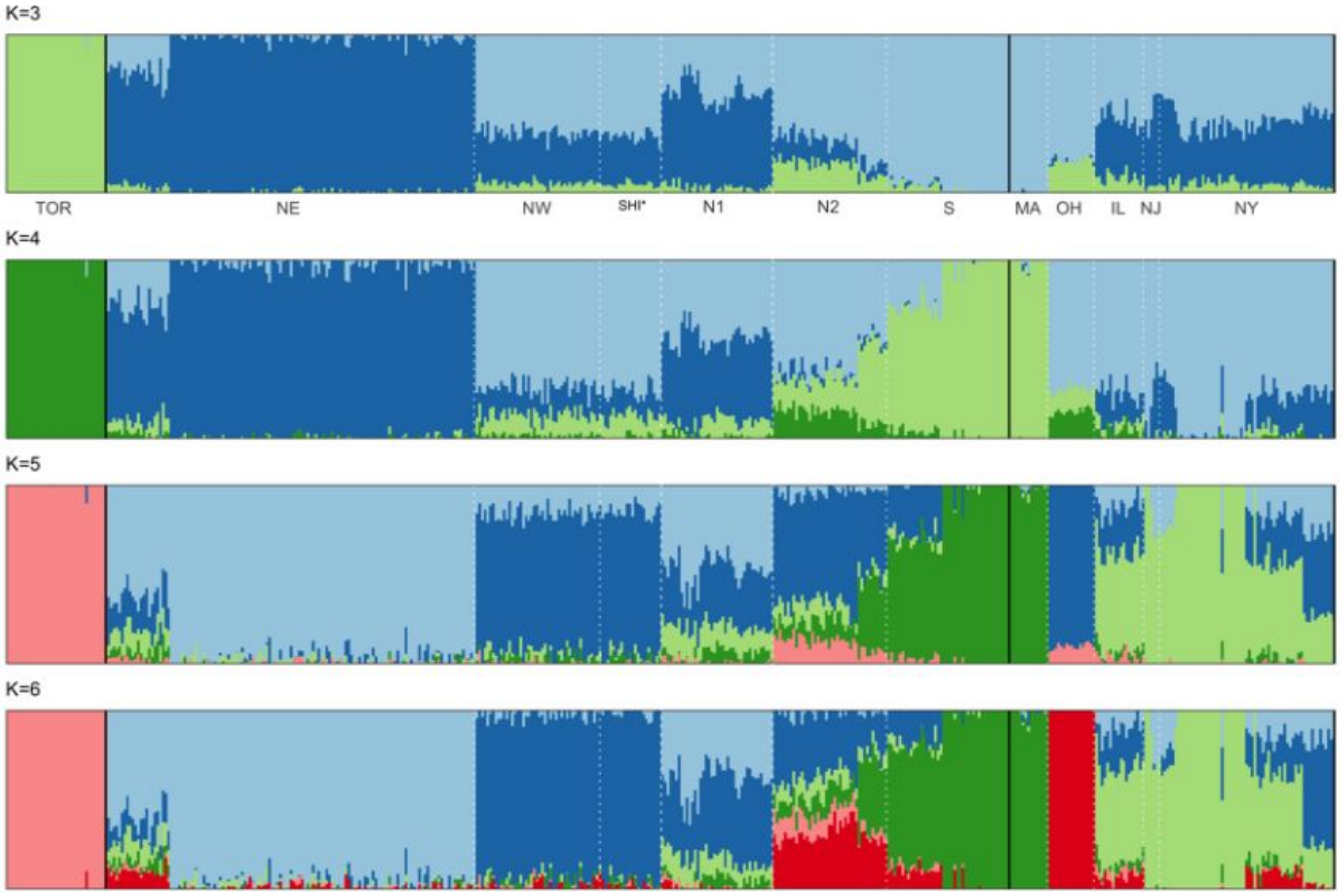
Case study 1

TOR (Canada) very different

Also OH, IL

Greater mixing in NY, NJ → NY

oldest (1999-2013), more sources?



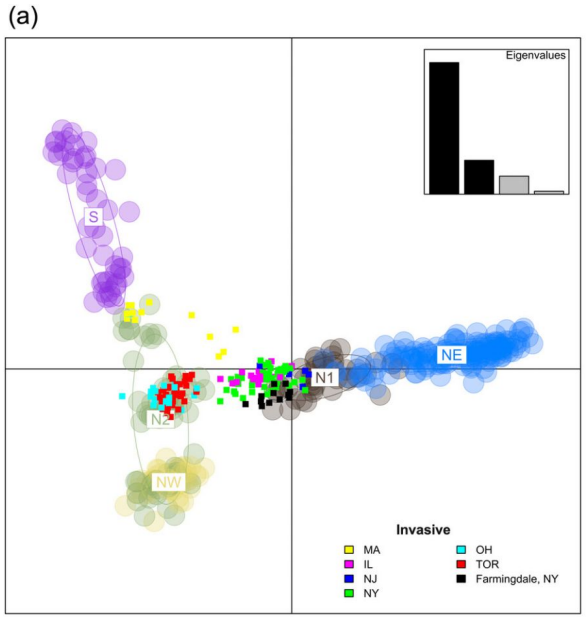
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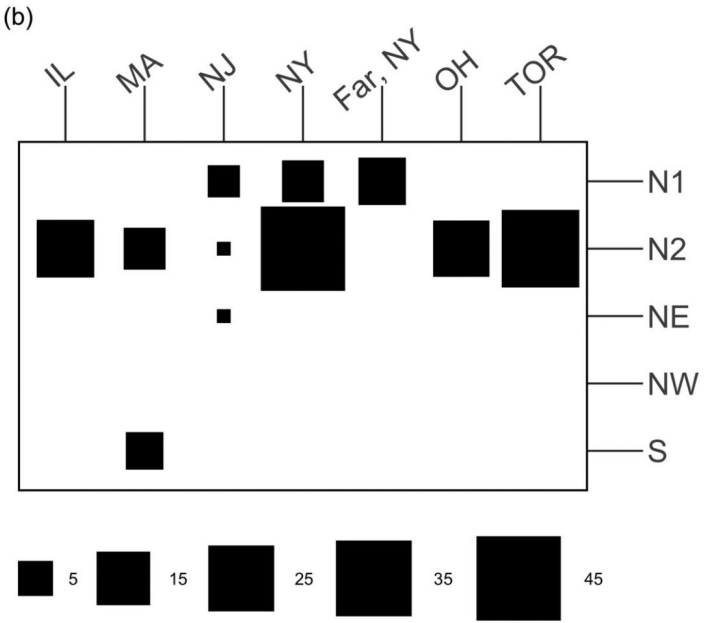
Case study 1

Population assignment

Used DAPC to assign invasive populations to native clusters

Most invasives assigned to N2 but also N1; NJ individuals from 2-4 sources





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Case study 1

Multiple independent introductions from the native range

Traced invasion pathways and spread patterns

Used demographic modelling to infer post-introduction bottlenecks, followed by expansions



Now set up to quickly identify intercepted individuals, and examine other invasive populations → genomic biosurveillance

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Case study 1

What kinds of questions can we ask?

- Origin and source populations: Where did the invaders come from? ✓
- Number of introduction events: Single vs multiple introductions? ✓
- Genetic bottlenecks and founder effects: How did the introduction affect genetic diversity? ✓
- Cryptic invasions: Can we detect hidden or morphologically similar species?

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Case study 2

Cryptic invasions relatively common for plants and invertebrates, where taxonomic identification can be hard

Typically require molecular methods to identify

Case study 2

Genomics detects cryptic wallaby invasion

Invasion Note | Open access | Published: 24 August 2024

Volume 26, pages 3997–4003, (2024) Cite this article



Biological Invasions

Aims and scope →

Submit manuscript →

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A. J. Veale, J. C. McEwan, R. Brauning, T. Van Stijn & A. D. M. Latham

1343 Accesses 2 Altmetric Explore all metrics →

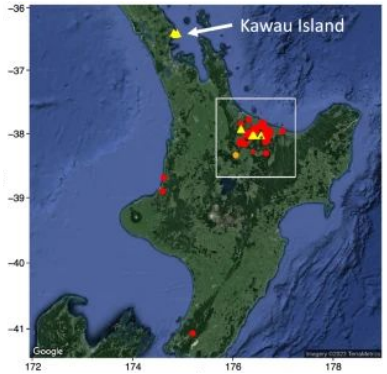
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Case study 2



Invasive tammar wallaby

Around 1870, at least four species of wallaby introduced to Aotearoa New Zealand, on Kawau Island (2,070 ha) in the Hauraki Gulf



Two of the smaller species – parma wallaby (*Notamacropus parma*), tammar wallaby (*Notamacropus eugenii*) of similar size and colour

Records not well-kept, historians largely assumed all on the island were tammar

Spread of tammar wallabies to North Island ~1912, now large range (~4,000 km^2) and damage to pasture, native plants, etc

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Case study 2



GBS data (16,796 autosomal SNPs)

Mitochondrial DNA (~800 bp) for species ID

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Case study 2

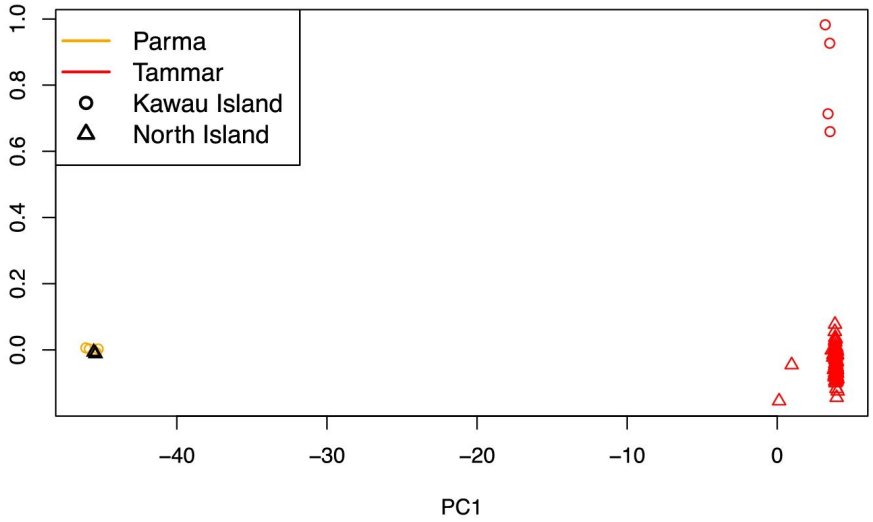
Two divergent species identified

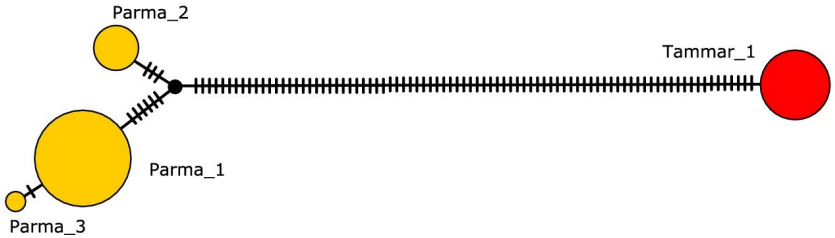
58% of SNPs were fixed differences

No hybridisation

Also found three parma wallabies in the BoP (southeast) region (expected only tammar)

Further work on 183 other samples found another 17 parma species IDs





Case study 2



BoP parma population undetected for at least 30 years

Unclear origins

Long period without detection highlights need for greater monitoring efforts...

... Especially those that include genomic methods

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Case study 2

What kinds of questions can we ask?

Origin and source populations: Where did the invaders come from?

Number of introduction events: Single vs multiple introductions?

Genetic bottlenecks and founder effects: How did the introduction affect genetic diversity?

Cryptic invasions: Can we detect hidden or morphologically similar species? 

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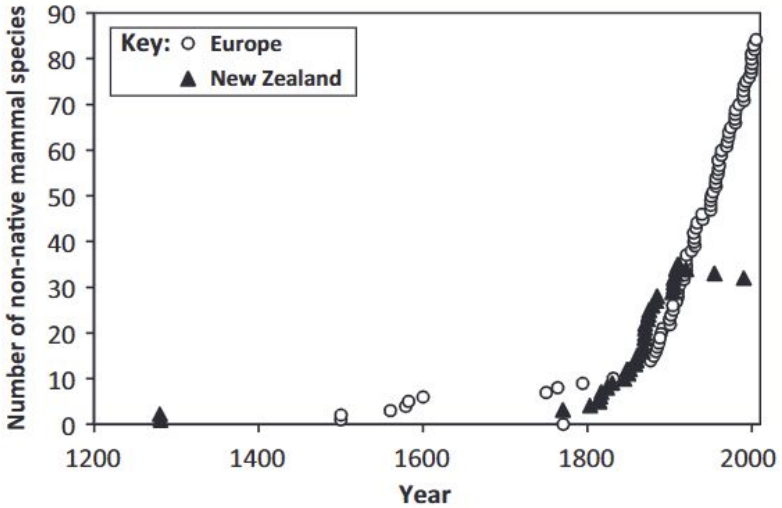
Genomic insights

Identifying invasion pathways

Detecting admixture: Mixing of different source populations can increase invasiveness

Predicting invasion success: Using genomic data to model potential spread and impact (e.g., based on GEA – Day Three)

...



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Stringent biosecurity based on risk assessment can reduce no. of invasions; DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tree.2012.07.013

Challenges and limitations

Sampling bias

Geographic coverage of the invasion is more important than the breadth of genomic coverage when only reconstructing invasion routes

Methodological biases

Some method assumptions (e.g., that populations are in migration-drift equilibrium → gene flow and F_{ST} estimates)

Demographic changes (e.g., founder/bridgehead effects) may weaken differentiation, impacting migration measures

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Challenges and limitations

Distinguishing between neutral and adaptive variation is often an important first step

Ethical and logistical issues in global sampling

- Everything is native (and possibly treasured) somewhere!
- Data sovereignty

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Future directions

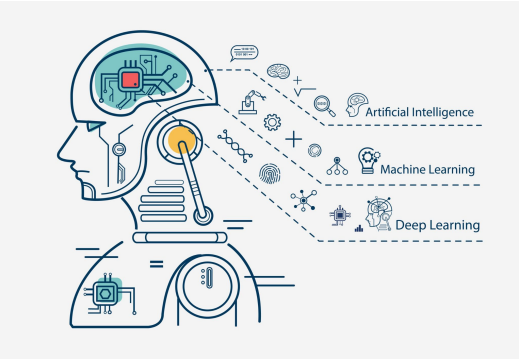
Integration with ecological and environmental data

For example, iNaturalist and GBIF

Real-time genomic surveillance (e.g., portable sequencers)

Machine learning and AI in invasion genomics





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Food for thought

Applied

- Can genomic data help prevent invasions?
- How might genomic tools be used in policy and management?

Fundamental

- How does standing variation in different populations influence invasion success?
- What role is admixture playing?

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Conclusions

Introduction is a key stage of invasion

Genomic data can elucidate population structure, invasion history, and subsequent spread, which may aid management

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Next steps

Course dataset

SCIENTIFIC REPORTS
nature research

Sci Rep. 2020 Jul 1;10:10788. doi: 10.1038/s41598-020-67397-5

Genome-wide patterns of differentiation over space and time in the Queensland fruit fly

Ángel-David Popa-Báez [1,2,✉,#], Renee Catullo [2,3,#], Siu Fai Lee [1,2], Heng Lin Yeap [2], Roslyn G Mourant [2], Marianne Frommer [4], John A Sved [4], Emily C Cameron [5], Owain R Edwards [2], Phillip W Taylor [1], John G Oakeshott [1,2]

Heredity

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nature > heredity > articles > article

Article | Open access | Published: 30 October 2023

Genomic signals of local adaptation across climatically heterogenous habitats in an invasive tropical fruit fly (*Bactrocera tryoni*)

Elahe Parvizi, Amy L. Vaughan, Manpreet K. Dhami & Angela McGaughran ✉

Heredity **132**, 18–29 (2024) | Cite this article

3998 Accesses | **6** Citations | Metrics



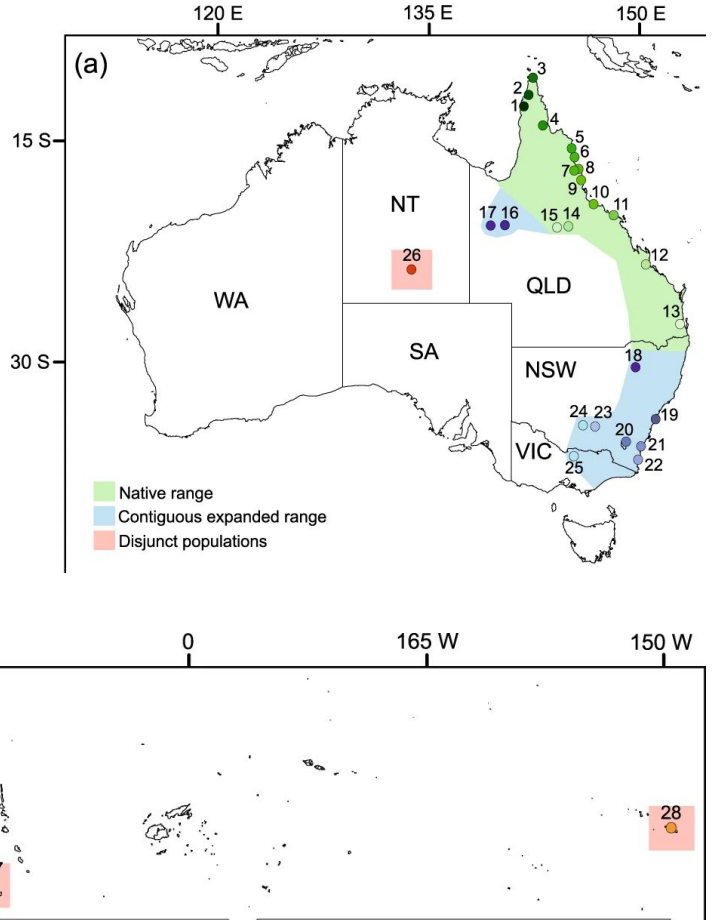
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Next steps

Invasive tropical fruit fly (*Bactrocera tryoni*) - Queensland fruit fly (Qfly)

Native to Australia; expanded range in temperate and arid Australia; invasive in tropical zones in the Pacific

28 populations, GBS



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Next steps



We are not focusing today on how the genetic data file we'll be using was created (Qfly.vcf), but it is important to note that some filtering steps have been applied:

Biallelic SNPs only, MAF < 0.05, high LD and missing data removed, resulting in a final dataset of 6,707 SNPs; see full steps at:

https://github.com/Elahep/B.tryoni_PopGenomics/tree/main/1-variant-calling

***Depending on the analysis type, we may wish to remove or retain multi-allelic SNPs, set a lower MAF threshold (or higher), not remove high-LD sites, etc

Next steps

Please move to the Day One tutorial

Remember to ask questions via slack!



CREDIT: SlideEgg PowerPoint template
www.slideegg.com

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